

KOREAN FOR TRAVELERS

Real Conversations for Every Situation

From airport to restaurant to emergency — natural Korean dialogues with pronunciation and cultural tips.

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Airport & Immigration

Arriving at Incheon International Airport (ICN) — the most common entry point to Korea



AT IMMIGRATION (입국심사)

Officer 방문 목적이 무엇인가요?

Bang-mun mok-jeok-i mu-eo-sin-ga-yo?

What is the purpose of your visit?

관광입니다.

You

Gwan-gwang-im-ni-da.

I'm here for tourism.

Officer 얼마나 머무실 예정인가요?

Eol-ma-na meo-mu-sil ye-jeong-in-ga-yo?

How long are you planning to stay?

2주 동안 머물 예정입니다.

You

I-ju dong-an meo-mul ye-jeong-im-ni-da.

I'm planning to stay for two weeks.

Officer 숙소 주소가 어떻게 되나요?

Suk-so ju-so-ga eo-tteo-ke doe-na-yo?

What is your accommodation address?

서울 명동 호텔에 묵을 예정입니다.

You

Seo-ul Myeong-dong ho-tel-e mu-gul ye-jeong-im-ni-da.

I'll be staying at a hotel in Myeongdong, Seoul.

 **Tip:** Immigration officers at Incheon usually speak some English, but knowing these phrases shows respect and speeds things up. Have your return ticket and hotel booking ready to show.

AT CUSTOMS (세관)

Officer 신고할 물건이 있으신가요?

Sin-go-hal mul-geon-i i-sseu-sin-ga-yo?

Do you have anything to declare?

없습니다.

You

Eop-seum-ni-da.

Nothing to declare.

AIRPORT VOCABULARY

공항	<i>gong-hang</i>	airport
입국심사	<i>ip-guk-sim-sa</i>	immigration
세관	<i>se-gwan</i>	customs
수하물	<i>su-ha-mul</i>	baggage / luggage
탑승구	<i>tap-seung-gu</i>	gate
환전소	<i>hwan-jeon-so</i>	currency exchange
관광	<i>gwan-gwang</i>	tourism / sightseeing



Hotel Check-in & Requests

Everything you need from arrival to checkout

CHECK-IN (체크인)

체크인 하고 싶은데요.

You

Che-keu-in ha-go si-peun-de-yo.

I'd like to check in.

Staff 예약 성함이 어떻게 되세요?

Ye-yak seong-ham-i eo-tteo-ke doe-se-yo?

What name is the reservation under?

제 이름으로 예약했어요. [이름]입니다.

You

Je i-reum-eu-ro ye-yak-haess-eo-yo. [name]-im-ni-da.

I made a reservation under my name. It's [name].

Staff **여권 보여주시겠어요?**

Yeo-gwon bo-yeo-ju-si-gess-eo-yo?

Could you show me your passport?



REQUESTING ITEMS (프론트 요청)

수건 좀 더 가져다 주시겠어요?

You

Su-geon jom deo ga-jyeo-da ju-si-gess-eo-yo?

Could you bring more towels?

와이파이 비밀번호가 뭐예요?

You

Wa-i-pa-i bi-mil-beon-ho-ga mwo-ye-yo?

What's the Wi-Fi password?

에어컨 작동이 안 돼요.

You

E-eo-kon jak-dong-i an dwae-yo.

The air conditioning isn't working.

체크아웃은 몇 시까지예요?

You

Che-keu-a-ut-eun myeot si-kka-ji-ye-yo?

What time is checkout?



Korean Hotel Tip: Most Korean hotels have a key card that controls the room's electricity — insert it into the slot by the door when you enter. Also, room slippers are provided and it's normal to wear them inside.



Restaurant & Ordering Food

Korea's food culture is unique — use these to navigate it like a local



GETTING A TABLE (자리 잡기)

두 명이에요.

You

Du myeong-i-e-yo.

There are two of us.

자리 있어요?

You

Ja-ri i-sseo-yo?

Do you have a table available?

Staff **이쪽으로 오세요.**

I-jjo-geu-ro o-se-yo.

Please come this way.



ORDERING (주문하기)

저기요!

You

Jeo-gi-yo!

Excuse me! (calling a server)

이거 주세요.

You

I-geo ju-se-yo.

I'll have this one, please. (pointing at menu)

삼겹살 2인분 주세요.

You

Sam-gyeop-sal i-in-bun ju-se-yo.

Two servings of samgyeopsal, please.

맵지 않게 해주세요.

You

Maep-ji an-ke hae-ju-se-yo.

Please make it not spicy.

물 한 잔 주세요.

You

Mul han jan ju-se-yo.

One glass of water, please.



PAYING THE BILL (계산하기)

계산해 주세요.

You

Gye-san-hae ju-se-yo.

Check, please. / I'd like to pay.

카드 돼요?

You

Ka-deu dwae-yo?

Can I pay by card?

따로따로 계산해 주세요.

You

Tta-ro-tta-ro gye-san-hae ju-se-yo.

Please bill us separately.

💡 **Restaurant Culture:** In Korea, you call the server by saying **저기요!** (jeo-gi-yo) — it means "Excuse me" and is never rude. Tipping is NOT expected and can be awkward. Water is usually self-service (무료 — free). Many restaurants have a call button on the table.

KOREAN	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
맛있어요!	<i>ma-si-sseo-yo</i>	It's delicious!
맛없어요.	<i>ma-deop-sseo-yo</i>	It doesn't taste good.
너무 매워요.	<i>neo-mu mae-wo-yo</i>	It's too spicy.
알레르기 있어요.	<i>al-le-reu-gi i-sseo-yo</i>	I have an allergy.

KOREAN	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
채식주의자예요.	<i>chae-sik-ju-ui-ja-ye-yo</i>	I'm a vegetarian.
영수증 주세요.	<i>yeong-su-jeung ju-se-yo</i>	Please give me a receipt.
포장해 주세요.	<i>po-jang-hae ju-se-yo</i>	Please pack it to go.



Transportation

Subway, bus, taxi and KTX — getting around Korea



SUBWAY (지하철)

명동역 어떻게 가요?

You

Myeong-dong-yeok eo-tteo-ke ga-yo?
How do I get to Myeongdong Station?

이 열차가 홍대입구역 가나요?

You

I yeol-cha-ga Hong-dae-ip-gu-yeok ga-na-yo?
Does this train go to Hongik University Station?

어디서 갈아타야 해요?

You

Eo-di-seo ga-ra-ta-ya hae-yo?
Where do I transfer?



TAXI (택시)

경복궁으로 가주세요.

You

Gyeong-bok-gung-eu-ro ga-ju-se-yo.
Please take me to Gyeongbokgung Palace.

여기서 세워 주세요.

You

Yeo-gi-seo se-wo ju-se-yo.
Please stop here.

얼마예요?

You

Eol-ma-ye-yo?
How much is it?

카드로 낼게요.

You

Ka-deu-ro nael-ge-yo.
I'll pay by card.

💡 Transport Tips:

- Buy a **T-money card** (티머니) at any convenience store — works on subway, bus and taxi nationwide. Tap

to pay, much cheaper than buying tickets.

- **Kakao Taxi** app is the best taxi app — shows price estimate, accepts foreign cards, has English mode.
- Subway announcements are in Korean, English, Chinese and Japanese.

KOREAN	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
...역	...yeok	...Station
다음 역	da-eum yeok	next station
종점	jong-jeom	last stop / terminus
출구	chul-gu	exit
입구	ip-gu	entrance
환승	hwan-seung	transfer
버스 정류장	beo-seu jeong-nyu-jang	bus stop



Shopping

Myeongdong, Dongdaemun, Olive Young — shop like a local

💰 ASKING PRICES & BUYING (가격 흥정)

이거 얼마예요?

You

I-geo eol-ma-ye-yo?

How much is this?

좀 깎아 주세요.

You

Jom kka-kka ju-se-yo.

Can you give me a discount?

이거 살게요.

You

I-geo sal-ge-yo.

I'll take this.

다른 색 있어요?

You

Da-reun saek i-sseo-yo?

Do you have this in another color?

입어봐도 돼요?

You

I-beo-bwa-do dwae-yo?

Can I try this on?

영수증 주세요. 면세 되나요?

You

Yeong-su-jeung ju-se-yo. Myeon-se doe-na-yo?
Receipt please. Is this tax-free?

💡 Shopping Tips:

- **Tax Refund (환급)**: Foreigners can get VAT (10%) refunded at the airport on purchases over ₩30,000. Look for "Tax Free" signs.
- Bargaining is OK at **Dongdaemun** and traditional markets, but NOT at Olive Young, department stores, or convenience stores.
- **Olive Young** (K-beauty) has an English app with member discounts — download before you go.



Asking for Directions

Get back on track when you're lost

📍 FINDING PLACES (길 찾기)

죄송한데요, 길 좀 여쭙봐도 될까요?

You

Joe-song-han-de-yo, gil jom yeo-jwo-bwa-do doel-kka-yo?

Excuse me, may I ask for directions?

경복궁이 어디예요?

You

Gyeong-bok-gung-i eo-di-ye-yo?

Where is Gyeongbokgung Palace?

지하철역이 어디예요?

You

Ji-ha-cheol-yeok-i eo-di-ye-yo?

Where is the subway station?

걸어서 얼마나 걸려요?

You

Geo-reo-seo eol-ma-na geol-lyeo-yo?

How long does it take on foot?

길을 잃었어요.

You

Gi-reul i-reo-sseo-yo.

I'm lost.

KOREAN	PRONUNCIATION	DIRECTION
오른쪽	<i>o-reun-jjok</i>	right
왼쪽	<i>oen-jjok</i>	left
직진	<i>jik-jin</i>	straight ahead

KOREAN	PRONUNCIATION	DIRECTION
여기	<i>yeo-gi</i>	here
저기	<i>jeo-gi</i>	over there
근처	<i>geun-cheo</i>	nearby
멀어요	<i>meo-reo-yo</i>	it's far
가까워요	<i>ga-kka-wo-yo</i>	it's close

1 2
3 4

Numbers & Prices

Korea uses two number systems — Sino-Korean for prices, floors and phone numbers

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pal

9

구

gu

10

십

sip

100

백

baek

1,000

천

cheon

10,000

만

man

100,000

십만

sim-man

💡 Price Examples:

₩5,000 → 오천 원 (o-cheon won)

₩15,000 → 만오천 원 (man-o-cheon won)

₩50,000 → 오만 원 (o-man won)

When shopping, you can simply say the price in English — most vendors understand. Or just show the number on your phone calculator.



Emergency Phrases

Korea is very safe, but know these just in case

Medical Emergency

살려주세요!

sal-lyeo-ju-se-yo — Help me! / Save me!

구급차를 불러주세요!

gu-geup-cha-reul bul-leo-ju-se-yo — Call an ambulance!

Emergency number: **119** (fire & ambulance) | Police: **112**

Police / Lost Items

도둑이야!

do-du-gi-ya — Thief!

지갑을 잃어버렸어요.

ji-ga-beul i-reo-beo-ryeo-sseo-yo — I lost my wallet.

경찰을 불러주세요.

gyeong-cha-reul bul-leo-ju-se-yo — Please call the police.

Lost & Found: ☎ **182** (Korean Lost Property Center)

Hospital / Pharmacy

병원이 어디예요?

byeong-won-i eo-di-ye-yo — Where is the hospital?

약국이 어디예요?

yak-gug-i eo-di-ye-yo — Where is the pharmacy?

여기가 아파요.

yeo-gi-ga a-pa-yo — It hurts here. (pointing)

Most large hospitals have English-speaking staff. Search "foreigner-friendly hospital Korea" for a list.

💡 **Safety in Korea:** Korea ranks among the world's safest countries. The streets are well-lit, CCTV is everywhere, and people are generally very helpful to lost tourists. If you need help, ask at any convenience store (GS25, CU, 7-Eleven) — staff can often help or call for you.

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